

New England

Massachusetts · New Hampshire · Rhode Island · Connecticut · Port: Boston

New England's soil is thin and rocky, so farms are small. The ocean is where the wealth is. Fishermen catch far more fish than people can eat. They dry or salt the extra fish so it keeps.

Forests give lumber, and the ports of Boston and Newport build ships. You have 7 ships, the most of any colony. That is your biggest advantage. The Southern Colonies and the West Indies have no ships, so they must pay someone to carry their goods.

Rhode Island has distilleries, factories that make rum out of molasses. Molasses comes from the West Indies, so you must trade for it first. Game rule: hold 2 molasses before you trade each 1 rum. Your biggest challenge is that your best product depends on someone else's.

The history behind the rum is hard. The molasses was made by enslaved Africans, who were forced to work and never paid. Ships from Newport carried rum to West Africa and traded it for captured people. Then they carried those people across the Atlantic Ocean in chains. That forced crossing is called the Middle Passage. New England grew no sugar, but its ships and rum were part of the slave trade.

You have: fish, whale oil, lumber, rum, and 7 ships.

WORDS TO KNOW

Distillery

A factory that turns molasses into rum. Rhode Island had many.

Molasses

The dark syrup left over from making sugar. It is cheaper than sugar, and rum is made from it.

Enslaved / Slavery

An enslaved person was held as property and forced to work without pay, for life. Their children were enslaved too. We say enslaved person, not slave, because slavery was done to them. It was not who they were.

The Middle Passage

The forced voyage of captured Africans across the Atlantic Ocean to the Americas. It was the middle leg of the triangle. People were chained below deck for weeks, with little food or air, and many died. Those who lived were sold into slavery.

Export / Import

To export is to sell goods to another place. To import is to buy goods from another place.

Raw Materials

Things from nature, like lumber, fish, tobacco, and furs, before they are made into goods.

Naval Stores

Pine tar and resin used to keep wooden ships from leaking. Every shipbuilder needed them.

NEW ENGLAND IN THE GAME

Starts with 7 Dried Fish, 3 Whale Oil, 5 Lumber, 6 Rum

Ships Owns 7 ships.

Middle Colonies

New York · New Jersey · Pennsylvania · Delaware · Port: Philadelphia

Farms in the Middle Colonies grow huge amounts of wheat and corn, far more than people can use. The region was called the breadbasket of the colonies. There are plenty of cattle and forests for lumber. Traders also get furs from Native Americans, and furs sell for a high price in England.

You have 2 merchant ships. That is enough to trade on your own, but not to carry much.

Your biggest advantage is that every region needs food, and you grow it. Your biggest challenge is that wheat and cattle are heavy and cheap. Here is a plan: sugar sells for a high price in England. Trade your wheat for sugar in the West Indies. Then carry the sugar to England.

That trade has a hard history. The sugar islands grew almost no food, because nearly every field was sugar cane. Middle Colonies wheat, cattle, and lumber fed and built the plantations where enslaved Africans were forced to work. They had been carried across the Atlantic in chained ships. That forced crossing is called the Middle Passage. Slavery was legal in the Middle Colonies too. New York City had one of the largest numbers of enslaved people of any colonial city.

You have: wheat and grains, lumber, cattle, furs, and 2 ships.

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Things from nature, like lumber, fish, tobacco, and furs, before they are made into goods.

Cash Crop

A crop grown to sell for money, not to feed your own family. Tobacco, rice, and sugar are cash crops.

Monopoly

Being the only seller of a product. Everyone who wants it must come to you.

MIDDLE COLONIES IN THE GAME

Starts with 7 Wheat & Grains, 7 Lumber, 5 Cattle, 7 Furs

Ships Owns 2 ships.

Southern Colonies

Maryland · Virginia · N. Carolina · S. Carolina · Georgia · Port: Charleston

Tobacco is the great cash crop of the Southern Colonies. You grow so much that the price drops, and England will not pay much for it. South Carolina grows rice, silk, and indigo, a plant that makes a blue dye England wants for its cloth. North Carolina makes naval stores: the pine tar and resin every shipbuilder uses to keep ships from leaking. Maryland adds fish, and traders bring in furs.

That is eight kinds of goods, the most of any region. That is your biggest advantage. Your biggest challenge is that you have no ships. Your ports, Charleston and Savannah, are full of goods that cannot move. You must pay New England, the Middle Colonies, or England to carry your cargo, or trade for a ship of your own.

The wealth of these plantations came from enslaved people. Planters forced enslaved Africans and their children to plant and harvest the tobacco, rice, and indigo, with no pay. In South Carolina, more than half of all the people were enslaved. Many had been carried from West Africa across the Atlantic Ocean in crowded ships. That forced crossing is called the Middle Passage. More captured Africans were brought to Charleston than to any other mainland port.

You have: tobacco, rice, naval stores, fish, lumber, furs, silk, indigo. No ships.

WORDS TO KNOW

Cash Crop

A crop grown to sell for money, not to feed your own family. Tobacco, rice, and sugar are cash crops.

Indigo

A plant grown in South Carolina that makes a deep blue dye. England wanted it for cloth.

Naval Stores

Pine tar and resin used to keep wooden ships from leaking. Every shipbuilder needed them.

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Duty

A tax on goods brought in from another place. In the game, duties usually go to England.

Mercantilism

The belief that colonies exist to help the home country. Colonies send it raw materials and buy its finished goods.

SOUTHERN COLONIES IN THE GAME

Starts with 7 Tobacco, 4 Rice, 5 Naval Stores, 1 Dried Fish, 4 Lumber, 2 Furs, 2 Silk, 3 Indigo

Ships None. This region has to hire a ship from another region.

West Indies

Jamaica · Barbados · Antigua · St. Kitts · Port: Kingston

The islands of the West Indies are covered with sugar cane plantations. Sugar is expensive and wanted all over the world, so you hold the most valuable product in the game. That is your biggest advantage.

Making sugar also leaves molasses, a brown syrup that New England's distilleries use to make rum. You have citrus fruit too: oranges and limes that keep sailors healthy.

This wealth came at a terrible human cost. Plantation owners forced enslaved Africans to plant, cut, and boil the cane in heat and danger. Most people on the islands were enslaved. They had been taken from their homes in Africa and carried across the Atlantic Ocean in chained, crowded ships. That forced crossing is called the Middle Passage. The people who made the sugar got none of its wealth.

Your biggest challenge is that the islands grow little else. Food and manufactured goods must all be brought in. You have no ships, so you must pay New England, the Middle Colonies, or England to carry your goods, or trade for a ship of your own. French, Spanish, and Dutch islands sell sugar too, so you must keep the English colonies buying from you.

You have: sugar, molasses, citrus fruit. No ships.

WORDS TO KNOW

Molasses

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WEST INDIES IN THE GAME

Starts with 4 Citrus Fruit, 9 Sugar, 15 Molasses

Ships None. This region has to hire a ship from another region.

England

The Mother Country · Port: London

You represent the merchants of England, the Mother Country. England believed the colonies were there to make England rich. That idea is called mercantilism. England makes nearly all the manufactured goods: guns, gunpowder, tools, books, clothing, and furniture. The colonies could not buy these from other countries. They had to deal with England.

You have the most ships in the game, 8. Your ships and your goods are your biggest advantages. When a chance card makes a ship pay a duty (a tax), those goods usually go to England.

Your biggest challenge is your needs list. It has more items than anyone's, and almost all of them come from the colonies: forest products for your ships, cash crops for English buyers, and food. You must trade with the colonies to get them.

English ships did more than carry goods. They took cloth, guns, and metal goods to West Africa and traded them for captured Africans. Then they carried those people across the Atlantic Ocean in chains. That forced crossing is called the Middle Passage. In the Americas, the people who lived were sold into slavery. The ships came home with sugar and tobacco grown by enslaved people. Port cities like Liverpool and Bristol grew rich from this trade.

You have: guns, gunpowder, clothing, fine furniture, tools, books, silver, and 8 ships.

WORDS TO KNOW

Mother Country

The nation that started and controls the colonies. Here, that is England.

Manufactured Goods

Goods made by skilled workers from raw materials, like tools, guns, clothing, furniture, and books.

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Duty

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Monopoly

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ENGLAND IN THE GAME

Starts with 4 Guns, 4 Gunpowder, 2 Clothing, 2 Fine Furniture, 3 Tools, 3 Books, 2 Silver

Ships Owns 8 ships.